



Covert help

Apparently NSA (National Security Agency) America's premier security agency has been helping Windows 7 strengthen its security measures.



Wind Top

A new machine from MSI's Wind Top line has just been released. It's based on the ION chipset and features a 21.5 inch multi-touch screen

Feature

With the launch of Windows 7 and its much vaunted touch functionality, we'll be seeing a wave of new touch interface gadgets like tablets and PCs built for the new OS. Will Windows 7 change the way gadgets are designed?

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7 *In touch... with tomorrow*

Windows has for long been the platform of choice for a vast majority of the modern world. It has a lot of elements working in its favour, when compared to say Mac or Linux. The OS is hardware agnostic – within reasonable confines, it will run on any hardware you put together, and you can actually run nearly all applications created including games without waiting for a OS specific version to come out. Another major benefit of the Windows ecosystem is diversity – PCs come in all shapes and sizes.

Since October 22, when Windows 7 was officially released to the world, a lot has been said about the all new OS. Now that the dust has settled, we agree that Windows 7 is way better than Vista. A clear indication of this, is the way 7 is selling, despite it still being the early days of its launch, as compared to the sales of Vista – 234 per cent higher according to research firm NPD Group.

Windows 7 is an operating system that many have hailed as one that quite simply does what it is supposed to and with all the visual eye candy that people expect from operating systems of today. Yet, it has maintained the spartan feel of a robust OS that can be customised for performance according to the hardware that you run it on. Surprisingly, it runs as fast even on some machines of yesterday compared to Windows XP, the last half decent release from Microsoft. Half decent because it still needed a service pack or two to iron out all the creases. With the launch of Windows 7, many users will probably be changing their operating systems for the first time in five or six years. Those that will be moving up from XP directly have surely only heard of the horrors someone or the other has faced with Vista and in the process are entirely skipping 7's younger sibling. The new OS is so light in fact that we are running it on an old

legacy machine that has a single core processor and barely five hundred megs of memory. Yes, this is probably the first time we have a Microsoft OS that can run on a lower configuration than its predecessor. Of course, on such a system you can't imagine doing Aero and some of the other bells and whistles; the classic mode sure comes in handy. The fact that it is light makes it an ideal operating system to enter the portability arena on top of the Atom processor. Reportedly, the OS devours less battery power too when running on portables.

Strangely, the journey to develop Windows 7 has not been an easy one for Microsoft. They enlisted a legion of testers, looked at a horde of usage sessions from previous versions, took a long time and resources to realise something that any average user can tell you within minutes – we just want an OS that is fast, light, boots quickly and does what it's supposed to do. Well, no matter the long and arduous